

GUIDE · TITLE INSURANCE

Title insurance, *without the fine print.*

Swipe

WHAT IT COVERS

02

Protection from what *already happened.*

Most insurance covers what might happen. Title insurance covers problems already in the home's past that the records search missed. You pay once, at closing.

- A forged signature in the chain of ownership
- An heir who never signed off
- A lien that was never released
- An error in the public records

TWO POLICIES

03

One protects the lender.

One protects you.

The lender's policy covers the lender's loan, and nearly every lender requires it. The owner's policy covers you, usually up to the purchase price, for as long as you or your heirs own the home.

> Bought together on a purchase, the lender's policy is a small add-on. Skipping the owner's policy rarely saves as much as it looks.

HOW PRICES ARE SET

04

It depends *on your state.*

- Set by rule in Texas, Florida and New Mexico: every company charges the same premium, so compare settlement fees and service
- Filed through a rating bureau in New York, New Jersey, Pennsylvania, Ohio and Delaware
- Filed by each company almost everywhere else, where shopping pays the most

YOUR RIGHTS

05

You can shop. *Here's what the law says.*

You can generally choose a qualified title company that isn't on your lender's list. Under RESPA, no one may pay or accept a kickback for steering your closing, and a seller can't require you to buy title insurance from a particular company.

THE TRADE-OFF

Fees from a provider you find yourself have no cap, so get that quote in writing.

MONEY LEFT ON THE TABLE

06

Ask for these *by name.*

- Texas refinances: a credit on the loan policy, 50% if your current policy is 4 years old or less, 25% if under 8
- Florida: reissue rates when a recent policy covers the home
- Elsewhere: ask for reissue and refinance discounts, and bring a copy of your prior policy

Free title calculators *and plain-English guides.*

kwalifai.com/title-services

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